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manufacturer over the past 25 years.

But somehow, it never quite caught up with the PlayStation 2 and the original Xbox when it came to the showdown during the last generation of consoles. People wrote off the company, saying it was past its prime. If anything, the Wii delivers an important lesson: never underestimate Shigeru Miyamoto.

The grand-daddy of video games and the creator of Mario set about envisioning a new console that would transcend the current gaming audience and truly appeal to a whole family at large. Drawing from the Japanese culture, he wanted to make video games a family experience. And boy, did he ever succeed.

Nintendo soon came out with the motion-sensing Wii. Why the name? The company explains: "Wii sounds like 'we', which emphasizes that the console is for everyone. Wii can easily be remembered by people around the world, no matter what language they speak. No confusion. No need to abbreviate. Just Wii."

Launched on September 14, 2006, the Wii has sold almost 50 million units worldwide so far. That's not a typo – fifty million units!

2.3.1 HARDWARE

Broadway Processor

With Sony and Microsoft both going to IBM for the microprocessor in their next-gen consoles, why would Nintendo be left behind?

The company approached IBM for a new processor as well, although its request was completely different from that of Sony and MS. Nintendo was looking for something that provided ample punch at a small size, was easy to manufacture and was not power-hungry.

This was a different challenge for IBM from the 'cutting-edge-technology' demands that it regularly gets. Soon, the Broadway processor was born.

Nintendo has notoriously shied away from discussing the details of its hardware, probably because of how poorly it compares to the other two next-gen consoles. Still, a few details have managed to leak over time.

Using a 90 nm fabrication process, the Broadway still manages to use 20 per